

ZAIRA CHRISTA BARAKAT

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PROFILE

Oxford-educated creative completing an MA in Cultural and Creative Industries at King's College London, with demonstrated expertise in art direction, campaign strategy, and brand identity across fashion, retail, and cultural events. Built and directed an independent fashion label from concept to catwalk and tripled ticket sales for Oxford's flagship fashion event through targeted social media strategy. Brings a culturally informed, research-led approach to creative work, fluency in Adobe Creative Suite, and advanced French.

EDUCATION

King's College London – MA Cultural and Creative Industries	2025 - 2026
University of Oxford, Somerville College – BA (Hons) Music, 2:1	2022 - 2025

EXPERIENCE

Zaira Christa Fashion Label <i>Founder and Creative Director</i>	London 2022 - Present
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- Founded an independent fashion label and brought two seasonal collections from initial concept through to runway presentation, directing all creative, production, and styling decisions independently.
- Built the label's brand identity across digital platforms, producing a portfolio of campaign imagery and editorial content that articulates a distinct creative point of view.

The Reach Brasserie <i>Bar Manager</i>	London 2025 - 2026
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- Managed day-to-day bar operations in a high-footfall venue, maintaining consistent brand standards across service, supplier relationships, and staff performance.
- Designed and launched a curated seasonal cocktail offering, balancing creative concept development with cost efficiency and commercial viability.

Oxford Fashion Gala <i>Co-Creative Director & Co-Marketing Director</i>	Oxford 2023 - 2025
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- Appointed to lead the end-to-end creative vision for Oxford's largest annual fashion event, producing a thematically unified show by directing concept development, casting direction, set design, and choreography from brief to live performance.
- Drove a 200% increase in ticket sales year-on-year by designing and executing a multi-platform social campaign that combined curated content, strategic collaborations, and a data-informed posting schedule.
- Delivered a cohesive campaign identity aligned with the Gala's creative vision, coordinating all audience-facing assets, copy, and promotional content across a team of volunteers.

Levi Strauss <i>Stylist</i>	London 2025
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- Exceeded sales targets during Black Friday, one of retail's highest-pressure trading periods, by delivering personalised styling consultations that increased units per transaction (UPT) above the team benchmark.

SELECTED PROJECTS

Tokyo Drift - Cultural Ethnography	Tokyo 2025
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- Produced a 10,000-word ethnography from three weeks of Tokyo fieldwork using participant observation, formal and semi-structured interviews, fieldnotes, and reflective journaling; analysed how sound, fashion, and movement shape subcultural identity.

Bekaa - Hospitality Brand Strategy	Independent MA 2025
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- Combined cultural, competitor, and market research with audience definition, operational planning, and financial planning to develop positioning and recommendations for a differentiated listening-bar concept.

SKILLS AND COMPETENCIES

Creative Software: Adobe Photoshop, Illustrator, InDesign, Premiere Pro

Languages: English (fluent), French (advanced), Arabic - Lebanese dialect (intermediate)

Creative Competencies: Art direction, visual storytelling, brand identity, creative strategy, campaign development, photoshoot production, social media strategy, content planning, trend research, cultural analysis